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A STUDY OF CONSUMER ADOPTION AND USAGE BEHAVIOUR OF UPI IN RAIPUR, CHHATTISGARH

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ABSTRACT:

Currently digital payments are growing at very high speed in India. This thing is changing the regular payment habits of people in both urban and rural regions. Unified Payments Interface which is called UPI has become one of the main payment option. It gain acceptance so fast because it is fast convenient and works on internet for everyday transactions.

Though on national level the transaction numbers are showing big growth but when we see at local level the acceptance and adoption is not same everywhere. It changes according to awareness trust convenience and how much customers are comfortable with new technology. In this situation the current study wants to understand utilisation of UPI services at local level in Raipur city Chhattisgarh. It also try to find out the behavioural usage pattern of these services.

This research is an empirical study. Primary data was collected mainly by questionnaire from sample of 100 customers. Some secondary data was also used from reports journals and e-payments publications. Findings of the study shows that sample has mostly embraced UPI and many of them are okay to accept UPI payments for their transactions. Main reasons which came out are comfort cost saving time efficiency and simplicity in using it. But still there are concerns like errors during UPI payments perceived security risks and many people are not fully digitally literate which affects their trust.

For long term adoption of UPI in Raipur just providing the technology is not enough. Building trust security and awareness about payment system is also very necessary otherwise objectives are not fully achieved. This research gives some local picture of digitisation happening in Tier-II cities of India.

Keywords: *Unified Payments Interface, Adoption, Digital Payment Behaviour, Perception of security, User-friendly, Financial inclusion, Raipur.*

INTRODUCTION

India has seen lot of change in its transaction market over the past ten years or so. Mobile phone connections went up and internet became much cheaper. That's why people are slowly leaving cash behind and going for electronic payments. World Bank also mentioned something about this in 2022. UPI played a big role because it made sending money between banks so easy just with mobile.

UPI started by NPCI back in 2016 as an instant payment service. You don't need to put full bank account number anymore. Mobile number QR code or virtual address is enough. And you even get instant status if it worked or not. This is why it became so common for normal day to day retail transfers. Apps such as PhonePe Paytm BHIM made it even simpler for everyone.

Small shopkeepers bus and taxi drivers tuition classes hawkers all of them have started taking payments through QR now. So digital payments is no longer only thing of big cities and proper banks. It entered into normal life and daily buying. Government is also running Digital India and trying to bring small merchants into online system which increased all this usage.

Still tasks are not that simple. People don't use UPI only because it's cheap or fast. They care about whether it's easy to operate if transaction actually goes through safety issues and if they themselves know how to use it properly. Many get scared when payment fails suddenly or server is down or no internet connection. News about cyber frauds also make them worry a lot and they lose trust.

In this research we are not looking at big macro picture or only big city people like most studies do. We want to check what is actually happening in Tier II cities. Places like Raipur in Chhattisgarh where phone transactions are increasing fast but people's trust and knowledge might be different. Not much proper research is done here. So this study tries to understand consumer behaviour about adopting and using UPI in Raipur area.

Research Objectives

1. To see how consumers in Raipur are taking up UPI.
2. To examine influence of perceived convenience towards UPI.
3. To find contribution of digital security on trust in UPI.
4. To explore importance of UPI for financial connectivity.

I. REVIEW OF LITERATURE

Past work have done some work on fast growth of mobile payments in India. Mostly of focus on UPI as retail payment system. They mostly say people like UPI more than old banking because its convenient. Transactions finish fast and interface is simple so users accept it quickly.

Some papers mention that usefulness effectiveness and easy to use features increase intention to keep using UPI. But convenience is not the only thing. Security plays big role for long term. People may start using because its easy but they only stick with it when they enjoy safety from fraud money loss or someone misusing their bank details. Failed or delayed transactions also hurt their faith badly.

Some other work are present which link UPI with financial inclusion. Digital way reduces costs and brings more people into formal banking. Merchants adopting QR codes and banks giving support helped small transactions a lot. Recent data shows UPI has become the top choice for retail payments across India.

But problem is most of these studies are on national level or only big metro cities. Emerging places like Raipur dont get much attention. Local problems trust issues reliability and usefulness in such cities are not studied properly. So there is clear necessity for small level research in Chhattisgarh region. This work will try to do that.

II. RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

The present investigation examines how consumers in Raipur, Chhattisgarh, use UPI. It is descriptive and analytical in nature. The research's focus is on how psychological components such as perceptions of security and convenience of utilization affect users' decision to stick with UPI and promote digital financial inclusion.

3.1 Study Type

The investigation is consumer-focused and empirical in character. Additionally, the study has been descriptive as its objective has been to investigate customer behaviour and attitudes around online payment systems. The study focuses on mobile based cashless transaction systems such as UPI rather than theoretical evaluations of payment systems.

3.2 Sources of Data

Data collected using questionnaire and data from credible sources form the basis of the work. A google form was utilised to gather data primarily from the aforementioned respondents, which included information on their demographics and UPI using habits. The NPCI and RBI statistics, government publications on digital payment systems, and published research papers on digital payments served as the secondary data source.

3.3 Sample Design

One hundred residents of Raipur, Chhattisgarh, were surveyed. Convenience sampling was chosen as the sample method due of the respondents' willingness to engage in the work and simplicity of access. The answerer came from various and distinct educational backgrounds and are either qualified or non-qualified users of digital payment applications. They are also employed, self-employed, and entrepreneurs.

3.4 Variable of the Study

According to this study, perceived security and comfort of utilization are the two reasons that ascertain customer behaviour. Easy to utilise refers to UPI's ease of use, convenience, and simplicity. Security is characterized by confidence in fraud prevention and payment system security. These will be evaluated based on modest UPI users' indications about the overall uptake of digital financial payment systems.

3.5 Analysis techniques

The percentage analysis, mean analysis, and correlation analysis is taken to sort, tabulate, and to work on the data. Age, gender, income, and consumption were all analysed using the percentage technique. Additionally, mean analysis was used to examine how the options' behaviour traits were perceived. The effects of utilization, security, and convenience of use were examined using correlation analysis.

III. ANALYSIS AND DISCUSSION

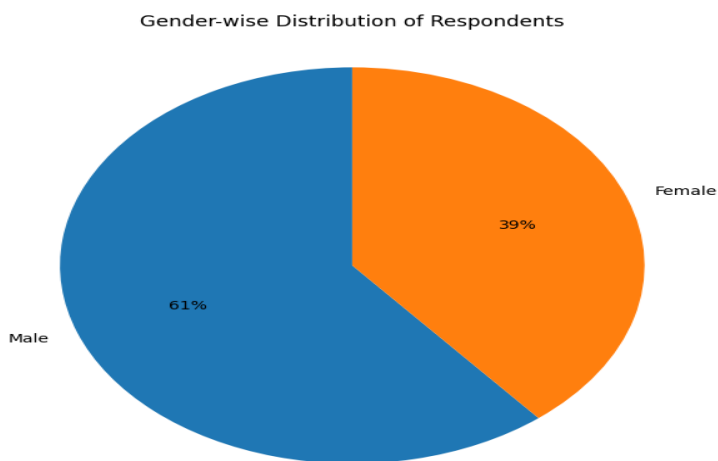
Here we have presented the analysis of primary data sample of 100 respondents from Raipur, Chhattisgarh. It has been analysed for the purpose of knowing the demography of the respondents, the acceptance of UPI and examining the pattern of association among the perceptions of ease to use, secured to use and the digital financial inclusion. The data has been analysed and put in tables for easy understanding through percentage distribution, mean and correlation values.

4.1 Gender Based Distribution of the Sample

Table 1: Gender Based Distribution of the Sample

Gender	Amount of Sample	In %
Male	61	61%
Female	39	39%
Total	100	100%

Figure 1: Gender Based Distribution of the Sample



This section outlines the quantum of female and male users in the sample; 61 per cent of our sample participants are males and 39 per cent females. The data reveals relatively larger numbers of males, but it is also evident that the numbers of females are also quite good to imply that females are also using mobile payment apps. This reveals that payments using the mobile UPI have become a common practice and not the preserve of a select few in the market.

4.2 A View of UPI's Adoption

Table 2: Use of UPI for Online Transaction

Response	Amount of Sample	In %
Yes	85	85%
No	15	15%
Total	100	100%

The work's output indicates that 85% of sample utilizes cashless mobile based payment apps using UPI for mobile payments and only 15% do not. It is visible that there is high penetration of UPI in Raipur among the people. It can also be seen that adoption of mobile payments is not considered novelty or useful asset, but the mobile payment is considered as an everyday payment such as merchant payments, transferring money between friends or family members, making payments such as electricity, water and gas charges and mobile recharge. It can also be seen that a low proportion of users which outlines that people are interested to use mobile payments.

4.3 Analysis of Mean Scores of the Behavioural Variables

To get a picture of what respondents thought of the main behavioural variables considered in the study, a mean analysis of respondents' score to the structured questionnaire was carried out.

Table 3: Mean value of variables

Variable	Mean Value
Perceived Ease of Use	3.69
Perceived Security	3.47
Digital Financial Participation	3.56

A mean of 3.69 for a moderate level of expected simplicity of utilization points that a large proportion of consumers perceive simplicity of utilization, and intuitiveness of UPI apps. This suggests interface designing ease of mobile payments, instant confirmation on payment and minimal input in payments are important factors to bolster continued consumer usage of UPI.

The mean value of perceived security 3.47 suggests a moderate level of security trust. This shows that despite the satisfaction of users with the use of UPI, there is lack of belief in the promise of anti-fraud, server down and money-back is yet to be attained. Security is important to instil trust.

Likewise, the mean of 3.56 for digital financial participation reflects that the UPI usage has resulted in an increase of the respondents' digital (mobile app) formal participation in digital financial activities. Real time money transfers, online payments to merchants and availability of electronic financial services (UPI) through apps have resulted in more regular online payments.

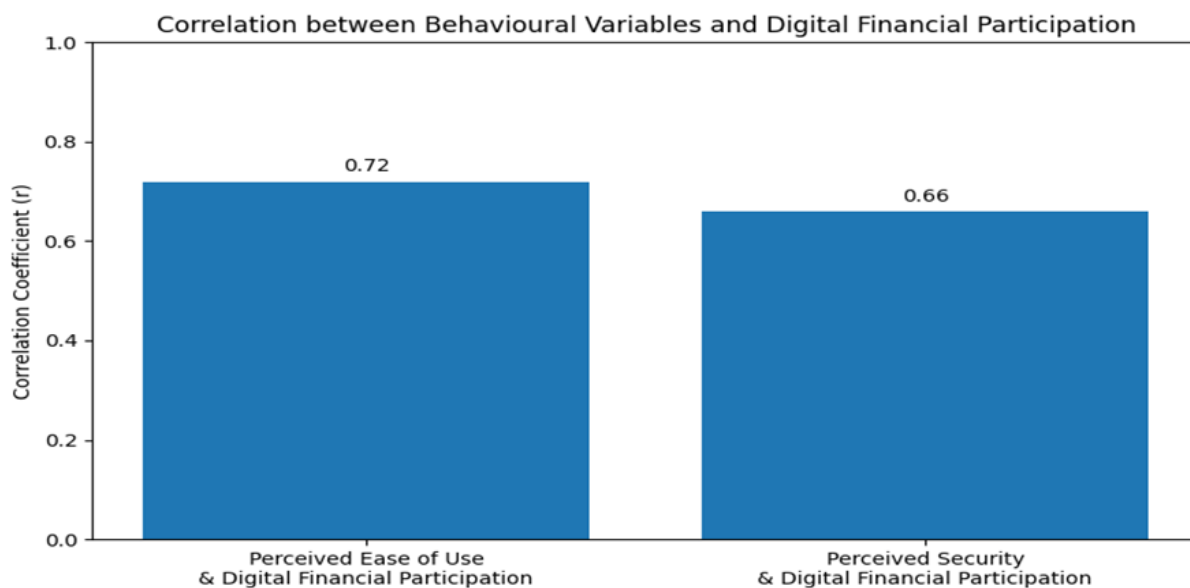
4.4 Analysis of Relationship between Behavioural Variables

Correlation analysis was taken to check the correlation between independent behavioural variables and the sample's involvement in digital financial behaviour.

Table 4: Correlation Analysis for Behavioural Variables & DFP

Variables	Correlation Coefficient (r)
Perceived Ease of Use & Digital Financial Participation	0.72
Perceived Security & Digital Financial Participation	0.66

Figure 2: Correlation Analysis for Behavioural Variables & DFP



The correlation coefficient of 0.72 between expected simplicity of utilization and electronic financial participation indicates that they go hand in hand. It means that people, who perceive that the UPI simple to utilize, are interested to use electronic financial services. So, expected simplicity of utilization is the most imminent factor impacting the use.

Conversely, the value of the degree of correlation between security and electronic financial services - 0.66 - also implies a considerable positive relation. So, it's clear that the greater the perceived security of

electronic transactions is, the more likely the consumer is to accept ingoing financial transactions via an app. Although the worth of security is slightly smaller than the measure of simplicity of utilization, it is a key behavioural element affecting trust.

Therefore, we can infer that while the influence of simplicity of utilization and protection are positive determinants for UPI, the influence of simplicity of utilization is marginally greater.

4.5 Discussion of Findings

The descriptive analysis undoubtedly shows the success of UPI amongst consumers in and around the city of Raipur. The very high number of users illustrates that now consumers are utilizing mobile payments as a component of their lives. But consumers are adopting for extra than just the technology being available. Results of behavioural research depicts that consumers are utilizing UPI mainly because it has some advantages like convenience (fast cashless payment, easy payments) and mobility (available all the time).

The average score of security perceptions also implies that payment security is not up to the mark with convenience. Though consumers are using UPI because of its convenience there may be concern with the failure rate and cyber security. So, the long-term solution to foster mobile payment behaviour is not only dependent upon availability of services but the stability of the technology and efforts to build trust.

IV. CONCLUSION AND LIMITATIONS

This study mainly focus to find out how much UPI is actually utilised in Raipur Chhattisgarh. We try to explain that UPI has became one big part of consumers day to day money matters. Data mostly come from 100 users. Many people in this sample they said they use mobile payment apps almost regularly now. So mobile payments has changed it is not just option to cash it become must for normal transactions.

Survey show that main reason people using UPI is its simplicity. When customers feel app is easy to use and they get instant confirmation they prefer it more. Average score for simplicity was high and there was good connection with how much they participate in electronic payments. So our result also support this that when customer payment habit changing they want easy service.

There is also positive correlation we found between UPI utilisation and perceived security. But in sample trust level was not very high. Trust get affected because of payment errors technical problems and fear of security breach. That means even adoption increasing fast but full confidence is still missing. In practice UPI growing because it is practical and fast but for long time adoption people need to trust that transaction safe and complaint handling is good.

In the end this report shows UPI role in helping Raipur customers develop cashless habit. Usage of UPI increased a lot because QR payment to shops peer to peer money transfer and mobile banking became easy. But for keeping this cashless behaviour continue we need better digital literacy prevent frauds and fix technical issues quickly.

But this study also have some limitations. We used convenience sampling and sample size only 100 so it not represent whole Raipur customers behaviour. Study only done in one urban area so results can be different in other cities or rural places.

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